

Page 03 — The Book /book.html

Audited: 6 September 2026 · repository `bccody03/blog-site` @ `main c0a998a` (merged into the audit branch)
Live URL: `https://blakecody.com/book.html` — HTTP 200. *Live currently serves the previous deploy (Last - Modified: 2026-09-04); this audit reflects `main` , which is ahead.*
Method: static HTML parse · headless Chromium render · direct probe and binary inspection of `chapter-1.pdf` · `robots.txt` and sitemap check · read of the chapter-gate path in `app.js`
Status: Audit only — **no code changes applied**. Every entry is a proposed change with the exact edit.

12	1	4	7	11
CHANGES	CRITICAL	HIGH	MEDIUM / LOW	PAGE-02 FIXES
PROPOSED				VERIFIED

Page 02 is essentially closed VERIFIED

`main` moved again (commit `c0a998a`, "SEO audit pass 2"). Re-checked against the code:

ID	Fix	Verification
T16	Pagination URLs	✓ Pagination removed entirely — no <code>page-btn</code> anywhere. Every essay now sits on one crawlable URL. This was the recommended option, and it is the right one.
T18	Archive schema	✓ <code>CollectionPage</code> + <code>BreadcrumbList</code> , with <code>@id</code> references back to the homepage graph
T19	RSS link	✓ now on every page, this one included
T20	<code>og-image.png</code> 404	✓ file restored (91 KB) alongside the JPEG
T21	Dead <code>maxPosts</code> config	✓ removed
C13	Archive title	✓ "Essays on Discipline, Love & Living with Intention Blake Cody"
C14	Archive description	✓ 149 chars, with "free to read" and cadence
C15	Archive H1	✓ "Essays on discipline, love and living with intention"
C16	Heading order	✓ now H1 → H2 → H2, no skip
C19	Archive intro copy	✓ static words 50 → 159
K11	Card position tracking	✓ <code>track("click-substack-card-" + idx, ...)</code>
K10	Pagination click tracking	Obsolete — the measurement existed only to decide T16 , and T16 was solved by deleting pagination. Correctly not implemented.

Also verified on this page: `entryContext()` is spread into **both** Formsprees payloads (chapter and reflect)
 ✓ — **K6** is fully done, not half done.

Correction to the page-01 UI report CORRECTION

In `ui/changelog-01-index.pdf` I raised finding **V7**: "You own a beautiful book cover and never show it," pointing at `cover.jpg` (1350×1800, portrait).

That was wrong. `cover.jpg` is a photograph of you at the 2025 U.S. Open — it is now used on `about.html` with exactly that alt text. I inferred "book cover" from the filename and the portrait aspect ratio without checking where it was used.

The corrected finding is **T24** below, and it points the other way: **there is no book cover image anywhere on the site**, so this is an asset to create rather than one to display. That changes the work from "add an `<img>`" to "commission or design a cover", which is worth knowing before you go looking for a file that does not exist.

The related finding **V8** ("no photograph of Blake anywhere") has since been fixed — `blake.jpg` now appears on the homepage and in the `Person` schema. ✓

Do these in this order

P0 — this week

1. **T22** Decide what the chapter PDF is for, then close the gap. It is currently a public, indexable, text-extractable file linked from your own HTML.
2. **C20 C21** Title and H1 — the phrase "Lead with Love, Live with Intention" appears in neither.
3. **T23** Add `Book` schema on the page that is about the book.

P1 — this month

4. **C22** Meta description — the page's own copy is better than its snippet
5. **T25** Heading structure (H1 → H3 → H3, no H2)
6. **K15** Track that the gate was *seen*, not just submitted — without the denominator the number is unreadable
7. **C24** Extend the free excerpt; 108 words is too short for the cut to hurt
8. **T24** Commission a cover image — schema, social and the page all need one

A. Technical

T22 The "gated" chapter is a public, crawlable, indexable PDF

CRITICAL

NOW — MEASURED

```
$ curl -I https://blakecody.com/chapter-1.pdf
200 · 61,389 bytes · application/pdf

PDF internals: producer "ReportLab PDF Library", /Font present,
                embedded IBM Plex Serif, real text operators
                -> the full chapter text is machine-extractable

robots.txt:     User-agent: *
                Allow: /                nothing excludes it

book.html:      <div class="chapter-done" id="chapter-done" hidden>
                <a id="chapter-dl" href="chapter-1.pdf" download=...>
                a plain crawlable link, no rel="nofollow".
                `hidden` hides it from readers, not from crawlers.
```

WHY IT MATTERS

1. **The gate does not gate anything.** The URL is guessable, publicly served, and linked from your own markup. Anyone who wants the chapter without giving an email already can — and the email is the entire purpose of the gate.
2. **The PDF competes with this page in search.** Google indexes PDFs as standalone results. A query matching the chapter's opening — and that opening is distinctive, emotional prose that could match real queries — can return `chapter-1.pdf` instead of `book.html`. You would be outranked by your own lead magnet, on the one page that carries the signup form.
3. **You cannot fix it with `noindex`.** Meta robots tags do not exist in a PDF, and the `X-Robots-Tag` HTTP header is not settable on GitHub Pages. The usual answer is unavailable to you.

FIX — DECIDE WHAT YOU ACTUALLY WANT FIRST

Option A — the email matters most. Keep the gate and make it hold:

```
1. Move and rename the file to something unguessable
   /c/8f3a2b1c4d/aligned-chapter-1.pdf

2. Remove the static href; set it only after a successful submit
   <a id="chapter-dl" href="#" download="Aligned-Chapter-1.pdf">...</a>
   dl.href = CHAPTER_PATH;    // in the submit success branch

3. robots.txt
   Disallow: /c/
```

This is not airtight — nothing served from a static host can be — but it closes the search-result leak and the guessable filename, which are the two ways this actually fails in practice.

Option B — reach matters more than the email. Publish the chapter as HTML on this page. Then:

- The content is indexable, on your domain, in your design, and it is *yours* — not a PDF result with no navigation and no signup form.
- Given **C4** (nothing on this domain ranks because almost nothing is on it), **a full chapter of real prose in HTML would be the single strongest piece of indexable content on blakecody.com.** It is

around 3,000 words of distinctive first-person writing on a subject people search for.

- The signup moves below the chapter as a soft ask — "if this was useful, here's where the rest lives" — which converts worse per-visitor and better per-reader.

Minimum, today, whichever you choose later: add `Disallow: /chapter-1.pdf` to `robots.txt` and remove the static `href`. That is ten minutes and stops the bleeding.

My read: you are early enough that reach is worth more than a list. Option B, and revisit when the traffic exists to trade.

T23 No structured data, on the one page where `Book` schema belongs HIGH

NOW

Measured: **0** JSON-LD blocks on `book.html`. Meanwhile `index.html` declares a `Book` node for *Aligned* whose `url` points here, and `articles.html` now has `CollectionPage` + `BreadcrumbList`. The book page is the only content page left with nothing.

`og:type` is correctly set to `book` ✓ — but none of the `book:` Open Graph properties are present.

FIX

Reuse the `@id` the homepage already defines, so the two declarations reconcile into one entity rather than describing two different books:

```
<script type="application/ld+json">
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@graph": [
    { "@type": "Book",
      "@id": "https://blakecody.com/#aligned",          // same id as the homepage
      "name": "Aligned",
      "alternateName": "Aligned: Lead with Love, Live with Intention",
      "author": { "@id": "https://blakecody.com/#person" },
      "inLanguage": "en",
      "abstract": "A field guide for anyone rebuilding after heartbreak – three
                    parts: decoding love, building yourself, living with intention.",
      "url": "https://blakecody.com/book.html",
      "image": "https://blakecody.com/book-cover.jpg"    // see T24
    },
    { "@type": "WebPage",
      "@id": "https://blakecody.com/book.html#webpage",
      "url": "https://blakecody.com/book.html",
      "isPartOf": { "@id": "https://blakecody.com/#website" },
      "about":    { "@id": "https://blakecody.com/#aligned" } },
    { "@type": "BreadcrumbList",
      "itemListElement": [
        { "@type": "ListItem", "position": 1, "name": "Home",
          "item": "https://blakecody.com/" },
        { "@type": "ListItem", "position": 2, "name": "The Book" } ] }
  ]
}
```

Plus the OG properties for a book:

```
<meta property="book:author" content="https://blakecody.com/" />
<meta property="book:tag" content="relationships" />
<meta property="book:tag" content="personal growth" />
```

ONE CAUTION

Do not add `offers`, an `isbn`, a `datePublished` or an `aggregateRating`. The book is unpublished — your own copy says "I'm in the process of becoming an author" — and fabricating those is both a structured-data violation and exactly the kind of thing that costs you the trust this page is built on. If you want the status in the graph, `"bookEdition"` can be omitted and the `abstract` can say it plainly. Add `offers` the day there is something to buy.

T24 There is no image on the page — and no book cover anywhere on the site

MEDIUM

NOW — MEASURED

images on book.html: ["logo.png"] the 30×30 header mark, and nothing else

Site-wide image inventory:

File	What it actually is	Used on
blake.jpg	author portrait	homepage + Person schema ✓
cover.jpg	photograph of Blake at the 2025 U.S. Open	about.html
hero-bg.jpg	abstract topographic background	homepage hero
og-image.jpg	generic social card	every page
book cover art	does not exist	

WHY IT MATTERS

- The Book schema in T23 wants an image. Without one the entity is thinner than it needs to be.
- Shares of this page fall back to the generic site card, so a link to your book looks identical to a link to your privacy policy.
- Image search returns nothing for the book.
- A book page with no picture of the book asks a stranger to take it on faith.

FIX

You need cover art. It does not have to be a finished publisher's jacket — a typographic treatment in Fraunces on your existing cream-and-rust palette, rendered at 1400×2100, would do everything required here and cost an afternoon. Export a 1200×630 variant for og:image on this page specifically, so a shared book link shows the book.

Until that exists, the honest interim is a pull-quote block from the excerpt set in large Fraunces — something for the eye to land on that is not a stock photograph.

T25 Heading structure runs H1 → H3 → H3, with no H2 MEDIUM

NOW — MEASURED IN THE RENDERED DOM

```
H1 Aligned
H3 Keep reading – get the full chapter.    the gate card
H3 It's on the way 📧                     the success card (hidden)
```

Both H3s are interface chrome. Nothing in the document structure marks the excerpt, and the actual chapter title — **"Grieving a Ghost — The Person You're Mourning Never Existed"**, which is the most distinctive, most searchable line on the page — sits in a `<p class="excerpt-chapter">`.

FIX

```
<h1 class="book-title">Aligned</h1>
<h2 class="excerpt-label">Read the opening of Chapter 1 – free</h2>
  <h3 class="excerpt-chapter">Grieving a Ghost – The Person You're
    Mourning Never Existed</h3>
<h2 class="gate-heading">Keep reading – get the full chapter.</h2>
```

Styling does not have to follow the tag — keep the current visual weights and change only the elements. That gives a clean H1 → H2 → H3 tree and promotes a genuinely strong line into a heading, where it can earn its own search visibility.

T26 The PDF is not in the sitemap LOW

Correct as it stands, given T22 — you do not want to invite indexing of a file you are trying to gate. Noted only so the decision is deliberate: if you take Option B and publish the chapter as HTML, the PDF stays out of the sitemap; if you take Option A, it stays out and gets a `Disallow` as well.

B. Content & text

C20 The title buries the book's actual title HIGH

NOW

```
<title>The Book – Aligned – Blake Cody</title>    31 chars, three em-dash segments
```

It leads with "The Book", which is a navigation label. And the subtitle — **Lead with Love, Live with Intention**, the phrase that is your book's subtitle, your homepage H1, and the line most likely to be searched by someone who half-remembers it — does not appear at all.

CHANGE TO

```
Aligned: Lead with Love, Live with Intention – Blake Cody    56 chars
```

Or, to catch the free-chapter intent that this page is built to serve:

```
Aligned by Blake Cody – Read Chapter 1 Free    43 chars
```

The first is better for the long game (owning your own book title); the second converts better from a results page. If you can only pick one, pick the first — the second is a description job, and **C22** handles it.

C21 The H1 is one word HIGH

NOW

```
<h1 class="book-title">Aligned</h1>
<p class="book-subtitle">Lead with Love, Live with Intention</p>
```

Third page in a row with this exact shape — the homepage and the archive both had it, and both are now fixed. Same fix here.

CHANGE TO

```
<h1 class="book-title">Aligned<!-- keep the display size -->
  <span class="book-subtitle">Lead with Love, Live with Intention</span>
</h1>
```

Move `.book-subtitle`'s existing styles onto the span and set it `display:block`. The page looks identical; the H1 gains the full title.

C22 The description is weaker than the page's own copy MEDIUM

NOW

Aligned: Lead with Love, Live with Intention – read the free opening
of Chapter 1. 82 chars of ~155

The best sentence on this page is already written, in your second paragraph: *"a field guide for anyone rebuilding after heartbreak and trying to become someone they're proud of."* That is the search intent — people look for help after a breakup, not for a book called Aligned — and it is missing from the snippet entirely.

CHANGE TO

Aligned by Blake Cody – a field guide for rebuilding after heartbreak:
decoding love, building yourself, living with intention. Read Chapter 1
free. 148 chars

C24 The free excerpt is 108 words MEDIUM

NOW — MEASURED

.excerpt-free: 3 paragraphs, 108 words
hidden remainder in the DOM: none (verified – see the pass below)

The excerpt cuts mid-sentence — *"The person we are imagining a future with, ready to walk through life with..."* — which is the right instinct. But 108 words is not enough for the cut to hurt. A reader has not yet invested anything, so the gate arrives before the desire it is supposed to convert.

It is also the only chapter prose indexable on the domain, which for a page whose subject is that chapter is very thin.

FIX

- **If you keep the gate (T22 Option A):** extend the free portion to 400–600 words — far enough in that stopping is genuinely annoying. That is the mechanism a content gate runs on.
- **If you publish (T22 Option B):** the whole chapter, and this finding disappears.

C25 No internal links out of the page body LOW

Apart from the header nav, the footer and the "← Home" eyebrow, the page body links nowhere. A reader who finishes the excerpt and decides not to hand over an email hits a dead end.

Add two sentences after the gate linking to the archive and to Reflect, with descriptive anchor text — "the essays these ideas came out of" and "write to me about yours". That gives the page internal links with real anchor text, which it currently has none of.

C23 This is the best-written page on the site KEEP

Measured: **371 static words** of genuine first-person prose — more than the homepage and the archive combined before their rewrites. Nothing in this report asks you to change the voice.

One structural note, offered as a suggestion rather than a finding. The page opens with *"I'm in the process of becoming an author — and honestly, it still feels surreal to write that."* That is disarming and it works on a reader who already trusts you. But the strongest sentence on the page — *"Aligned is that book. It's a field guide for anyone rebuilding after heartbreak..."* — is 90 words down, below the fold for a stranger arriving from a search result.

Consider opening with what the book *is* and moving the origin story to the second paragraph. You lose nothing — the person who wants the human version reads on and gets it — and you gain the visitor who is deciding in five seconds whether this is for them.

C26 The gate is honest — verified, and worth protecting PASS

I checked specifically for cloaking, because email gates are a common way sites drift into it. Measured:

```
document.getElementById('excerpt-more') → null  
hidden chapter text in the DOM → none
```

What Google receives is exactly what a reader receives: three paragraphs and a form. There is no hidden remainder served to crawlers and withheld from people. That is the correct implementation and it should stay that way if you extend the excerpt under **C24** — add real visible words, never a hidden block revealed by script.

Also correct on this page: `type="email"`, `autocomplete="email"`, `required`, a real `<button type="submit">`, and a visible success state. The form itself is well built.

C. Tracking & measurement

K14 Chapter downloads are undercounted, and you cannot tell by how much HIGH

NOW

`track("chapter-request", "Chapter 1 requested")` fires on successful form submit ✓ — correctly implemented in pass 1. But it is measuring one of three paths:

Path to the chapter	Tracked?
Form submit → auto-download	✓ yes
The fallback link ("tap here to download the PDF") after a failed auto-download	✗ no
Direct hit on <code>chapter-1.pdf</code> — from search, a shared link, or a guess (T22)	✗ invisible — never touches your JS at all

WHY IT MATTERS

Whatever number GoatCounter shows you for `chapter-request` is a **floor, not a total**, and the size of the gap is exactly the size of the T22 leak. If you read that number as "chapter reads" you will underestimate demand and over-estimate the gate's value at the same time.

FIX

```
// the manual fallback link
document.getElementById("chapter-dl").addEventListener("click", () =>
  track("chapter-download-manual", "Chapter PDF, manual link"));
```

Direct PDF hits cannot be measured by client-side analytics at all. Under T22 Option A, routing through `/chapter?t=...` gives you a measurement point and a gate in the same move. Under Option B the question dissolves, because the chapter becomes a page with a pageview.

Until then: when you read `chapter-request`, read it as a floor.

K15 You track the submit but not the impression, so the rate is unreadable MEDIUM

There is no event for a reader *reaching* the gate. Without that denominator, "12 chapter requests this month" could mean a 60% conversion rate on a page nobody finds, or 2% on a page that works. Those two situations call for opposite responses — one says promote the page, the other says fix the gate — and you currently cannot tell them apart.

FIX

```
const gate = document.getElementById("excerpt-gate");
if (gate && "IntersectionObserver" in window) {
  const io = new IntersectionObserver((entries) => {
    if (entries.some((e) => e.isIntersecting)) {
      track("gate-viewed", "Chapter gate seen");
      io.disconnect(); // once per pageview
    }
  }, { threshold: 0.5 });
  io.observe(gate);
}
```

Two events, one ratio. That ratio is what tells you whether C24's longer excerpt actually helped, which is otherwise a guess.

K17 Verified working on this page — leave alone PASS

- `chapter-request` event fires on submit ✓
- `entryContext()` — landing page, referrer and query — is spread into the chapter Formspree payload **and** the reflect one ✓ (K6 fully closed)
- The chapter form posts to a dedicated Formspree, separate from the newsletter and from Reflect ✓ — the right separation, and it means the chapter list can be mailed independently
- The note "this won't subscribe you to anything" is accurate to the implementation ✓ — worth keeping true
- GoatCounter over HTTPS, outbound Substack clicks tagged and tracked ✓

Evidence log

Check	Result
Repo vs live	Audited <code>main c0a998a</code> ; live still serves the 2026-09-04 deploy. Findings are against current code.
Static text in <code><body></code>	371 words — the highest on the site · rendered: 346 (the hidden success card accounts for the difference)
Title / description	31 chars / 82 chars
Headings	H1 → H3 → H3, no H2
JSON-LD	0 blocks (<code>index.html</code> : 5 nodes · <code>articles.html</code> : 2 nodes)
Images	<code>logo.png</code> only. No book cover exists anywhere in the repository.

chapter-1.pdf	200 · 61,389 bytes · application/pdf · ReportLab, embedded fonts, extractable text · linked from static HTML with no rel="nofollow" · no robots.txt exclusion
Cloaking check	#excerpt-more absent; no hidden chapter text in the DOM — clean
Excerpt	3 paragraphs, 108 words, cuts mid-sentence
Form	type="email" · autocomplete="email" · required · real submit button · entryContext() in the payload
Tracking	chapter-request on submit ✓ · no event on the fallback link · direct PDF hits unmeasurable

Page 03 of 7 complete. Remaining: reflect.html · about.html · 404.html · privacy.html .

Site-wide findings still open and cross-referenced rather than repeated: **T2** (client-side rendering), **C4** (articles hosted off-domain — see **T22** Option B, which is the same argument arriving from a different direction), **T13** (10-minute cache ceiling, a GitHub Pages limit).

The UI track is one page behind: ui/changelog-02-articles.pdf is still pending.

blakecody.com SEO change log · generated 6 September 2026